Employee Handbook

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Owner	Head of Human Resources, NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Applicability	All employees on the payroll of NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. at Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad and Gurugram offices
HR Contact	hr-helpdesk@novatech.example, ext. 4000
Internal Committee (POSH)	icc@novatech.example, ext. 4060

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1. Welcome, Purpose and Scope [ALL EMPLOYEES]

1.1 Purpose

Welcome to NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. ("NovaTech", "the Company"). This Handbook is a single guide to how we work: our values, the rules we follow, how performance and careers are managed, and what happens when employment ends. It summarises key rules. Where a detailed policy exists, this Handbook points to it.

1.2 Applicability

- This Handbook applies to all permanent employees from L1 to L7+.
- Fixed-term employees are covered for the period of their contract.
- Interns, trainees on stipend and third-party contractors are covered only by the sections on conduct, confidentiality, POSH, assets and social media. Their other terms are in their agreements.

1.3 Order of Precedence

1. The employment contract and offer letter.
2. The detailed policy on a subject (for example, the Leave Policy).
3. This Handbook.

If there is a conflict, the item higher in the list applies. The Company may update this Handbook once a year or when the law changes. HR will announce changes at least 15 days before they take effect.

2. Mission, Vision and Values [ALL EMPLOYEES]

2.1 Mission and Vision

- **Mission:** To build dependable technology services and products that help our clients grow, and to give our people a place where they can do their best work.
- **Vision:** To be the most trusted technology partner for our clients in India and abroad by 2030.

2.2 Our Values

Value	What It Means in Practice
Client First	We solve the client's real problem, keep our promises and share bad news early.
Integrity	We are honest in our work, our claims and our reports. We do not cut corners on ethics.
Ownership	We take responsibility for outcomes, not only tasks. We say what we will do and we do it.
Respect	We treat everyone with dignity. We value different views and backgrounds.
Collaboration	We share knowledge and credit, and we help other teams succeed.
Continuous Learning	We learn from mistakes, seek feedback and keep our skills current.

3. Code of Conduct (Summary) [ALL EMPLOYEES]

3.1 Core Expectations

Area	Expected Behaviour	Not Allowed
Honesty	Accurate reporting of time, expenses, leave and work	False claims, forged documents, misuse of sick leave
Respect	Courteous and professional behaviour with all	Bullying, discrimination, abusive language, intimidation

Area	Expected Behaviour	Not Allowed
Safety	Follow safety rules and report hazards	Violence, threats, weapons on premises
Substances	Come to work fit to perform	Working under the influence of alcohol or drugs, and use or sale of illegal drugs on premises
Company property	Use assets for official work	Theft, damage or misuse of Company property
Compliance	Follow the law and Company policies	Bribery, corruption, insider trading, tax or labour law violations

3.2 Anti-Discrimination

NovaTech is an equal opportunity employer. Decisions on hiring, pay, promotion and exit are based on merit and role requirements, and not on gender, religion, caste, region, language, disability, marital status, sexual orientation, age or any other protected characteristic. HR will provide reasonable accommodation for employees with disabilities.

3.3 Duty to Report

Every employee must report a suspected violation of the law or this Handbook to the manager, the HR Business Partner, or the Ethics Line (ethics-line@novatech.example), which accepts anonymous reports. Retaliation against a person who reports in good faith is a serious violation.

3.4 Detailed Rules

The full list of misconduct categories, investigation steps and penalties is in the Code of Conduct Policy (NT-HR-POL-003), Section 7.

4. Working Hours and Attendance [ALL EMPLOYEES]

4.1 Working Hours

- The work week is Monday to Friday. Standard hours are **9:30 AM to 6:30 PM**, with a 1-hour lunch break.
- A full day needs at least 8 working hours. A half day needs at least 4 hours.
- Employees must be available during Core Hours (11:00 AM to 4:00 PM) on all working days.

- The hybrid model (3 days in the office and 2 days WFH) and the anchor days (Tuesday and Thursday) are explained in the Work From Home Policy (NT-HR-POL-007), Section 2.

4.2 Attendance

1. Mark attendance in the HRMS every working day. For WFH days, mark attendance by **9:45 AM**.
2. A missing or wrong entry can be corrected within **2 working days**. More than 3 corrections in a month need a written justification from the manager. See the Attendance and Work Hours Policy (NT-HR-POL-002), Section 3.
3. Shift-based and on-call work follows the Attendance and Work Hours Policy, Section 5.
4. Leave must be applied for in the HRMS as per the Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001), Section 5. Absence without leave or information for 3 or more consecutive working days is unauthorised absence.

4.3 Public Holidays

The Company announces the holiday list for each year in January. The 2026 list is in the Leave Policy, Section 4.

5. Dress Code [ALL EMPLOYEES]

5.1 Standards

Occasion	Dress Standard
Regular office days (Monday to Thursday)	Business casual: collared shirts, kurtas, trousers, chinos, formal or smart-casual footwear
Fridays and festival days	Smart casual. Traditional wear is welcome on festival days.
Client meetings, client sites, interviews	Business formal or smart business casual, as the client expects
Video calls on WFH days	Neat and presentable. Same standard as a regular office day for the upper body.

5.2 Not Appropriate

Torn or very worn clothing, beachwear, clothes with offensive slogans, and sports shorts are not allowed in the office or in client meetings.

5.3 Accommodation

Employees may wear clothing required for religious, cultural or medical reasons. Employees with a medical need or a disability who need a change in the dress code should speak to the HR Business Partner. The Company will not refuse a reasonable request.

6. Anti-Harassment and POSH Policy [ALL EMPLOYEES]

6.1 Policy Statement

NovaTech does not tolerate sexual harassment or any form of harassment. This section follows the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. The Company applies the same standard of protection to all employees, whatever their gender.

6.2 What Is Sexual Harassment

It includes unwelcome conduct, by words, actions, messages, images or gestures, such as: physical contact or advances, a demand or request for sexual favours, sexually coloured remarks, showing pornography, and any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature. It applies in the office, at client sites, on business travel, at Company events, on WFH days (including video calls and chat), and in messages sent after working hours.

6.3 Internal Committee (ICC)

- An Internal Committee is set up at each office. It has a Presiding Officer who is a senior woman employee, at least 2 employee members, and 1 external member from an NGO or a person familiar with issues of sexual harassment. At least half of the members are women.
- Contact: icc@novatech.example or ext. 4060. A complaint can also be given to any ICC member in person.
- The names and numbers of ICC members are displayed in each office and on the intranet.

6.4 Complaint Process

Step	What Happens	Timeline
1. Written complaint	The affected person submits a complaint to the ICC with details and any evidence. The ICC will help in writing it if needed.	Within **3 months** of the incident, or the last incident. The ICC may extend by another 3 months with reasons.
2. Acknowledgement	ICC acknowledges the complaint	Within 3 working days
3. Conciliation (optional)	At the complainant's request, a settlement without a financial settlement	Before the inquiry begins
4. Notice to respondent	Copy of the complaint is sent to the respondent, who replies in writing	Reply within 10 working days
5. Inquiry	Both sides are heard and witnesses and evidence are examined	Completed within **90 days**
6. Report	ICC gives its findings to the Company and both parties	Within 10 days of the inquiry
7. Action	The Company acts on the recommendation	Within 60 days of the report

6.5 Protection During the Process

1. Confidentiality: The identity of the complainant, respondent and witnesses, and the details, are not disclosed to anyone except as the law allows.
2. Interim relief: On request, the ICC may recommend a transfer of either party, up to 3 months of leave for the complainant in addition to leave entitlements, or other relief.
3. No retaliation: Any adverse action against a complainant or witness is a separate violation.
4. A complaint that is not proved is not punished unless it is shown to be malicious. Not being able to prove a complaint is not the same as a malicious complaint.

6.5.1 Possible Action

Action may include a written apology, warning, withholding of increment or promotion, counselling, community service, and termination for serious cases, as per Section 12.

7. Conflict of Interest [ALL EMPLOYEES]

7.1 Rule

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests may affect, or seem to affect, their duty to the Company. If in doubt, disclose.

7.2 Common Situations

Situation	Rule	Action Needed
Second job, business or freelance work	Not allowed without written approval. Any work during Company hours or for a competitor or client is never allowed.	Seek approval from the Department Head and HR
Relative or close friend works at NovaTech	Allowed, but no one may be in the reporting line, hiring decision, pay decision or performance decision of a relative	Disclose to HR within 7 days
Financial interest of 2% or more in a client, vendor or competitor	Not allowed without approval	Disclose before acting on any decision involving it
Gifts and hospitality from clients or vendors	Gifts up to INR 2,000 each, and up to INR 5,000 a year from one source, may be accepted. Cash or gift cards are never accepted.	Declare gifts above the limit and return or hand them to HR
Directorship or advisory role in another organisation	Needs approval	Disclose to the Department Head and HR
Hiring or awarding a contract to a relative or a firm in which you have an interest	Not allowed	Disclose and withdraw from the decision

7.3 Annual Declaration

Every employee must submit a conflict of interest declaration in the HRMS by **31 January** each year, and update it within **7 days** of any change.

8. Confidentiality and Intellectual Property [ALL EMPLOYEES]

8.1 Confidential Information

Confidential information includes client data, source code, product plans, pricing, financial results, employee personal data, security details and any information marked Confidential. Employees must:

1. Use it only for the Company's work and share it only with people who need it.
2. Not copy it to personal devices, personal email or personal cloud storage. See the Information Security Policy (NT-IT-POL-001).
3. Not enter Confidential data into any external AI tool or online service that the Company has not approved.

The duty of confidentiality continues for **3 years** after the employee leaves. For trade secrets and client data, it continues without a time limit.

8.2 Intellectual Property

1. All work product created in the course of employment, or using Company time, equipment or information, belongs to the Company. This includes code, designs, documents, inventions and ideas.
2. Employees agree to sign any document needed to confirm this ownership.
3. Employees must not bring or use confidential information or code of a previous employer or any third party.
4. Contributions to open-source projects need written approval from the Engineering Head and Legal. The decision is given within 10 working days.

8.3 Personal Projects

An employee may own work created fully outside working hours, without using Company equipment or information, and unrelated to the Company's business or clients. The employee must disclose it to HR in case of doubt, and the Company will confirm in writing within 10 working days.

8.4 Permitted Disclosures

This section does not stop an employee from reporting a violation of the law to a government authority or making a report through the Ethics Line.

9. Social Media Policy [ALL EMPLOYEES]

9.1 Personal Use

1. Employees may use social media in their personal capacity, outside working hours and on their own devices.
2. Make it clear that your views are your own. A line such as "Views are personal" in the profile helps, but is not a defence for a violation.
3. Do not share Confidential information, client names, project details, unreleased products, or photos showing screens, whiteboards or badges with sensitive details.
4. Do not post content that harasses, threatens or discriminates against colleagues, clients or others, or that harms the Company's name. This applies to messages in private groups and chat groups as well.
5. Do not respond to media or analysts on behalf of NovaTech. Send such queries to comms@novatech.example.

9.2 Company Accounts and Official Communication

Only authorised members of the Marketing and Communications team may post on the Company's official accounts. Employees may share the Company's public posts and job openings.

9.3 Professional Networking

Announcing a new role, promotion or an award on a professional network is welcome. Clients may be named only if the client has allowed it, and with Marketing's approval. During the notice period, employees must not post about leaving in a way that discloses clients or projects.